

BIGARD MEMORIAL SEMINARY, ENUGU
Affiliate of the University of Ibadan
PHILOSOPHY DEPARTMENT
2nd Semester Examination 2023/2024 Academic Session

PHIL. III
BAF 301: African Traditional Religion

Answer any Three Questions:

Time: 3hrs

- 1a. Who is an ancestor? (b). What are the criteria for becoming an ancestor in traditional Africa? (20mks)
2. Mbiti distinguished between the living-dead and the long-dead. Briefly describe the process by which an ancestor can become a deity in African thought. (20mks)
3. Mention and explain the three levels of ATR. (20mks)
4. (A) what is sacrifice? (b). Identify any four types of sacrifice and discuss their purposes in ATR (20mks)
5. Discuss the idea of traditional African Conscience (20mks)
- 6a. What is sin from a traditional African perspective?
(b). Mention and explain any five ways of atoning for sins in ATR (20mks)

Good luck



UNIVERSITY OF IBADAN
DIRECTORATE OF AFFILIATED INSTITUTIONS
BIGARD MEMORIAL SEMINARY, ENUGU

BMS/IB/3019

Candidate's Number (write very clearly)

300

Level of Study

ARTS

Faculty/College

PHILOSOPHY

Department/Course

AFRICAN TRADITIONAL RELIGION

Title of Paper

30 - 05 - 2024

Date

Examination (insert official title)
of the Examination for which you
have entered, as it appears at
the head of the question paper

DIRECTIONS TO CANDIDATES

For Examiner's
Use Only

1. Write on both sides of the pages (except in Mathematics)
2. Begin each answer on a fresh page
3. Write the number of each question at the top of each page.
4. All rough work must be crossed through, and enclosed within this cover.
5. If supplementary books are used, they must be fastened together at the end of this book and inside the cover. Answers must not be written on the supplementary books unless all the leaves in this book have already been used.
6. In your own interest you should enter in the space provided below, the numbers of the questions which you have attempted (with sub-sections where necessary).
7. In no circumstances must answer books used or unused, be removed from the Examination Room by a Candidate.
8. Candidates are warned that importance is attached by the examination to accuracy and clearness of expression.
9. Please note that there is severe penalty for cheating at any examination.

Question No.	Mark
2	15
4	16
6	7
48	
CA	34
82	
Total...	

NUMBERS OF THE ANSWERS

in the order in which they have been written.

2, 4, 6

All students of the University of Ibadan are expected to show academic integrity at all times. Understanding this, I solemnly declare that I shall not be involved in any malpractice including soliciting, giving, receiving or using unauthorised aid in this examination.

Signature of student

NUMBER TWO

THE PROCESS BY WHICH AN ANCESTOR CAN BECOME A DEITY IN AFRICAN THOUGHT.

According to Mbiti, there are two groups of ancestors, the living dead and the long-dead or the dead of the distant past. The living dead are those who died recently and are still remembered by their living relatives. The long dead are those who died long ago with no one living who still remembers them. According to Mbiti it is the ancestors who are long dead that can become a deity.

However, not all the ancestors of the long dead that can be deified. Those who are deified are those who though they have died long ago, they still have influence on the living who do not know them or remember them.

They are raised to the status of a deity because they continue to inspire the living and influence their lives. ✓

An instance is when a Chief or a native doctor who because of ^{his} integrity, honesty and impartiality is deified many years after he has died because his life, personality and goodness still inspires the living and influence their lives, though they do not know him or remember him. In some instance the deified ancestor usurps the position of an earlier deity.

There, ^{fore} the process of deification follows from man through death becomes an ancestor (spirit) who through forgetfulness become a ghost and then through influence becomes a deity. ?

15

NUMBER 4A

WHAT IS SACRIFICE?

Sacrifice according to Aizinge is defined as an act of external or public worship made up of Oblation and immolation that signify the interior disposition with which the individual and community acknowledges God's infinite excellence and avows their subjection to him. Sacrifice also entails the acknowledgement of the superiority of a deity over man. The key concepts of sacrifice are thus

External:- This entails all the external materials, celebrations and ritual involved in sacrifice.

Oblation:- This entails the offering which is brought to sacrifice.

Worship:- This entails the acknowledgement of one's inferiority before a god or deity.

Immolation:- This entails the killing of the object of sacrifice, or the giving up of something which we consider of value.

Interior Disposition:- This is the intention with which an individual comes to make sacrifice.

Communion:- This entails that the sacrifice is a communion of the gods/spirits and man.

The Object of Sacrifice refers to that to whom sacrifice is made. It can be made to a god, a deity or minor spirit.

A

NUMBER 4B.

TYPES OF SACRIFICE.

1. Thanksgiving Sacrifice.
2. Propitiatory Sacrifice.
3. Funerary Sacrifice.
5. Expiatory Sacrifice.

Thanksgiving Sacrifice:- This is a sacrifice that is made to a deity in order to appreciate it for the favours granted to the individual making the sacrifice.

Propitiatory Sacrifice:- This is the sacrifice made in order to appease a god or deity who is believed to have been offended.

FUNERARY SACRIFICE:- This is a type of sacrifice made in order to facilitate the ~~rites~~ passage of the dead to the spirit world.

Expiatory Sacrifice:- This is similar to propitiatory sacrifice. While propitiatory sacrifice is directed to the offended deity, expiatory sacrifice is directed to the offender. It is a sacrifice made to cleanse and purify the offender. It is also known as sin offering.

NUMBER 6A

Sin in Traditional African perspective.

Sin in traditional African perspective is referred to as a violation of the moral code of the society. These moral codes are extracted from the customs which Africans believe were sanctioned by the gods/goddess.

African morality deals with ontological order which is made up of different forces including God, Man and other natural forces. Man is at the center of this ontological order and has the duty to maintain a good relationship of the moral ontological order. Hence when there is a violation or distortion of this ontological order sin is said to be committed.

There are three nuances of Sin in African traditional perspective.

(1) Sin (Njo):- This means the violation of the moral code either by offending a deity, nature or fellow humans.

(2) Taboo (Nso):- This refers to acts which are generally regarded by the community as forbidden. For instance the killing of ~~set~~ snakes in some communities.

(3) Abomination (Anu):- This refers to offending the law of nature such as incest, homosexuality and murders.

NUMBER 6B

METHODS OF ATONEMENT IN AFRICAN TRADITIONAL RELIGION

African Traditional Religion deals with sin, through atonement. The ways of atonement of sin includes.

- 1- Expiation
2. Payment by Compensation.
3. Divulgence.
4. Public Mockery/Chastisement.
5. Banishment.

Expiation:- This entail offering an expiatory sacrifice to the deity as a mode of atonement.

Payment by Compensation:- This entail payment of what was taken or what was broken. It is a form of restitution as a means of atonement.

Divulgence:- This entails making the offender to publicly confess his sins.

Public Mockery/Chastisement:- This involves publicly ridiculing the offender to serve as deterrent for others.

Banishment:- This means exiling the individual ~~for~~ from the community as a means of atonement.